

REport 1

Curated streets of koramangala

The people of Koramangala continue to suffer due to potholes, the one issue that persists even after a lifetime of complaints. The recent rains have yet again deteriorated the lanes. Interviews with the police, locals and commuters indicated that a mutual cooperation amongst all is hard to maintain but they are trying their level best to. A local shopkeeper, who happens to see the traffic throughout the day said that major accidents that happen due to potholes are usually at night after 12, since the traffic is less and the street lights don't really work, it gets hard for the driver to spot them. He also talked about how it is usually the two wheelers that get affected due to these. Another Auto driver mentioned how frequent these accidents are. "On an average two to three cases of serious accidents that cause significant injury or damage are reported every day, whereas 10-15 cases of minor loss such as dents, scratches etc." Since the driver travels throughout the city everyday, he named the major areas that have a huge number of cases are S.G Palya, Koramangala, H.S.R. Layout, Ballandur etc. He himself has suffered from a huge accident that happened due to the pothole, however due to the Labour Card that the government has made mandatory to be issued, he could claim insurance for the loss. He also hinted at the fact that it is usually the two wheelers who suffer the most due to the same but brought up the incidents of several domino-effect collisions that occur. "Everyone blames the driver but half the time the roads are the issue" said the driver. Several two-wheeler riders echoed this sentiment, saying that despite wearing helmets and following traffic rules, unpredictable road conditions make commuting unsafe. Considering safety concerns, at times due to water logging because of rains adds more to the problem. It damages vehicles and hides the real depth of the pothole making it more difficult to pass through. During peak hours, even small craters slow down traffic, while larger ones force two-wheelers to swerve dangerously into the path of cars and autos. However, Mr. Theertha Prasad, Head Constable of Traffic Police talked about how the police sends vehicles, both cars and motorcycles, usually referred to as Jackie and Kobra respectively amongst the officials on patrolling through the city, they officials are then informed about the situations and in case of improvement on the roads, they mark locations using GPS coordinations. All this information is circulated in a designated app named "BTP ASTraM" which is developed by the traffic police of Bengaluru. It helps Bengaluru residents to manage their travel, with features including real-time traffic updates, accident and violation reporting, fine payment, and event alerts. This is an initiative by the Greater Bengaluru Authority to maintain the city as a whole systematically. The photos are uploaded in the app and the concerned authorities look after the problems, usually ending up getting the issues solved. The traffic police officers usually forward the citizen's complaints to the authorities but the response

varies from the availability of labour, funds etc. Despite complaints, there are occasional signs of progress. Last week, workers were seen marking pothole clusters on 5th Cross Road, indicating possible repair plans. However, most residents argue that Koramangala's condition requires a more comprehensive road-restoration plan rather than scattered patchwork.

Report 2

Waste management around Lalbagh continues to be a growing concern as police report regular minor littering cases and residents argue that both the government and the public are responsible for the lack of cleanliness. Even though serious offences are rare, people who visit the area say that visible garbage around the park shows that the problem is far from solved. A police officer posted near the Lalbagh main gate said he does not usually deal with major waste-related violations. However, he mentioned that "two to three petty cases occur every week", mostly involving visitors dropping plastic bottles, food wrappers or tissues on the ground. According to him, these incidents seem small but add up over time, especially in a crowded place like Lalbagh. But for many pedestrians and regular visitors, the issue feels bigger. An independent pedestrian interviewed near the entrance said that "both the government and the public share the blame" for the condition of the area. She feels that even though authorities launch initiatives, they fall short because citizens do not cooperate fully.

"The government takes initiatives and tries to work, but it doesn't go hand in hand with the citizens who don't understand the depth of their actions," she said. She explained that even when waste bins are placed in the right spots, people still throw garbage around carelessly. According to her, this discourages the government from continuing strong action. "The government has no motivation to do so because they don't see much changing," she added. Her comments reflect the ongoing conflict between what residents expect and what officials are able to do. Lalbagh, being one of Bengaluru's most popular public spaces, attracts hundreds of visitors daily. This means even small lapses in waste disposal quickly become noticeable. Garbage near the gates, parking areas, and food stalls has been a regular complaint from locals. When asked about ways to reduce waste in the area, the pedestrian pointed to the work done by scrap collectors in the city. "The scrap collectors do a great job in collecting all those materials... hopefully they make good use of it and not waste it, instead get it recycled and things," she said. She believes that supporting them and encouraging more recycling can help reduce the pressure on the BBMP's waste system. Scrap collectors often pick up bottles, cardboard and plastic from the surroundings of Lalbagh, especially near busy points like the Double Road Gate. Many environmental groups have also said that the informal recycling sector plays a major role in managing the city's waste, especially when households and visitors don't segregate properly. On the question of how citizens can be encouraged to be more responsible, the pedestrian suggested financial rewards. "Making money out of selling that waste for better jobs," she said. According to her, if people know they can earn even a small amount by selling recyclable waste, they might be more motivated to separate it and avoid throwing it on the streets. Even though local groups and volunteers do organise clean-up drives around Lalbagh

once in a while, the police officer's weekly record of small littering cases shows that people's habits aren't changing very quickly. Officials also say that they cannot fix the problem with enforcement alone if citizens don't cooperate on an everyday basis. Many regular visitors point out that the inside of the park usually looks much cleaner because the maintenance staff works throughout the day. But just outside the main gates, especially near the footpaths and parking areas, garbage tends to pile up more often. Since these spots are crowded and busy, the litter becomes more noticeable and affects how people feel about the upkeep of Lalbagh in general. As Bengaluru grows and more people visit public places like Lalbagh, managing waste is becoming more challenging and clearly something everyone has to take responsibility for. Right now, the small but steady cases of littering and the mixed reactions from people show that improving the situation will need better systems from authorities and more active participation from citizens too.

Report 3

Behind the Counter: The Chemists Who Keep Wilson Garden Running

By – Mayank Thapa and Khyati Bhansali | Christ University | Field Report

In every busy neighbourhood, there are people who quietly support the daily life of the community without ever standing in the spotlight. One such place is Modern Pharma near Wilson Garden, where two young chemists, Mhd. Anas and Riyaz Maznoon, spend long hours serving customers who walk in with different needs. Most people stop by, take their medicines, and leave, but few know what the work behind the counter really looks like. When we visited the pharmacy around 7 p.m., the shop was already crowded. Even though the space was small, people kept entering one after another, asking for medicines for fever, cough, colds and other common issues. Watching the scene, it became clear how important a simple neighbourhood medical shop is for people living nearby. A Workday That Stretches from Morning to Midnight Anas has been working at Modern Pharma for one year, and he explained that the pharmacy opens at 9 a.m. and closes at 12 a.m. "Evenings are the busiest," he said, pointing to the customers waiting at the counter. Most of them seemed tired from work or worried about someone at home who was unwell. Even while speaking to us, Anas kept an eye on the counter. If a customer walked in, he immediately returned to attend to them, showing how the job demands constant attention. There is no fixed break or slow hour

in the evening. Riyaz, who has been working here for two years, added that the load becomes easier to handle because there are three staff members. "We share the work," he said. "One manages billing, one picks medicines, and one talks to customers." Watching them, this teamwork seemed very natural, built from working together every day. Training That Builds Confidence Before joining the pharmacy, Anas is completing his D. Pharm training course that will last two years. He said the training will help him understand the basics of medicines, dosages, and safety. "It's important to give the right medicine," he said simply. The statement showed how seriously he takes his role. In a pharmacy, accuracy is essential. A small mistake, even unintentional, can affect someone's health. The job demands focus, and it was clear that both Anas and Riyaz were aware of this responsibility. Riyaz mentioned something that highlighted Anas's strengths. "He understands customers well," he said. "Sometimes people don't explain clearly, but he figures out what they want." This observation showed that their work is not only technical but also people centred. Listening carefully and staying patient is an important part of the job. During rush hours, especially between 7 p.m. and 9 p.m., the pharmacy becomes extremely busy. People walk in after work, parents bring children, and elderly customers ask for regular medicines. Through all this, the chemists must stay calm and organised. Both Anas and Riyaz said that the key is teamwork. They divide responsibilities so customers do not have to wait too long. Observing them, it was clear that they function almost like a well-coordinated unit. Without needing to discuss anything loudly, each person automatically knew what task to handle. This routine may look ordinary from the outside, but standing inside the shop showed how much attention and multitasking the job requires. When asked about the toughest part of the job, Anas said something surprising. "People want the exact medicine written by the doctor," he said. "Not alternatives, even if the composition is the same." This becomes challenging when certain medicines go out of stock. Seasonal illnesses, sudden spikes in demand, and supply delays often cause shortages. Customers, however, may feel uncomfortable accepting a different brand. So, the pharmacy has a system. "We ask them to come the next day," Anas explained. "We take their number and call them when the medicine arrives." It is a simple but practical solution that helps people feel reassured instead of confused. Another interesting part of Modern Pharma is that a clinic is located right beside it. Many customers come directly from the doctor with a fresh prescription. Because of this, the chemists deal with a wide variety of patients every day children, elderly people, working individuals, and sometimes people who are experiencing discomfort or stress. Despite the pressure, the chemists maintain a steady and respectful way of speaking. The customers we observed seemed satisfied with the service. Some even mentioned that they preferred this pharmacy over others because of the clarity with which staff explain dosages and timings. Riyaz said that working with

Anas has been smooth because he is patient. “He doesn’t rush people,” he added. “He explains the dose properly.” These small interactions, which might go unnoticed, build trust between the community and the pharmacy. Standing inside Modern Pharma, it became clear that the work of chemists involves far more than stacking shelves or handing out boxes. They must understand prescriptions, answer questions, maintain stock, explain dosage, handle crowds, and stay alert for long hours. Yet they do all of this without expecting any special recognition. Their work is not dramatic or glamorous, but it plays a steady and essential role in the life of the neighbourhood. For many people, a pharmacy is the first stop before visiting a doctor, or the place they go when they need help late at night. Chemists like Anas and Riyaz quietly support all these needs through consistent and responsible work. As we left the pharmacy, the rush had still not slowed down. Customers continued to enter, some with prescriptions, others with questions. Both chemists returned to their work immediately, focused and calm. Their job may appear simple to people passing by, but spending time there showed how much effort goes into keeping a small community healthy. The pharmacy acts like a bridge between medical care and people’s everyday lives. And the individuals behind the counter like Anas and Riyaz are the ones who make that bridge strong. Their contribution may not always be visible, but it is steady, reliable, and deeply important to the smooth functioning of the neighbourhood.

Report 4

The first thing that stands out at Dyu Art Café is not the food or the art, but the feeling of entering a space that seems to slow you down. The noise of traffic from Koramangala fades as you step inside, replaced by soft music, low conversations, and the occasional scrape of a chair against the floor. Sunlight spills unevenly through the open structure, landing on wooden tables, textured walls, and small pieces of artwork that quietly demand attention without overwhelming the space. It feels warm, slightly messy, and lived-in not carefully polished, but comfortable. On a weekday afternoon, the café holds a mix of people. Some sit alone with laptops open, headphones on, fingers moving steadily across keyboards. Others sit in groups, leaning into conversations, laughing softly, sharing plates of food. There is a sense that everyone here is doing something different, yet somehow sharing the same rhythm. This balance between movement and stillness seems intentional, even if it isn’t planned. Tanseem, a college student, has visited Dyu Art Café several times before. She

comes here for different reasons depending on the day. “Sometimes when I want to do work and sometimes when me and my friends want to escape busy college schedules,” she said. As she spoke, she glanced around the café, pointing out how the space allows for both openness and privacy. There are areas where people sit close together, soaking in the energy of the place, and other corners where one can sit quietly without being disturbed. The ambience, according to her, plays a big role in why she keeps coming back. The smell of food travels easily across the café. Plates of pasta, drinks in tall glasses, and small snacks move past tables carried by servers who seem familiar with the space. Tanseem smiled while talking about the food, especially the white sauce pasta, which she mentioned as a favourite. It is not just about eating, but about how food fits naturally into the experience something comforting, familiar, and easy to enjoy while working or talking. What truly sets Dyu Art Café apart from her is the presence of art. “Many cafes in Bengaluru are pretty much the same with food and ambience,” she explained, “but the part where they sell art and have many artistic elements makes it different.” The artwork is not placed like decoration meant only to fill empty walls. Instead, it feels like a part of the café’s identity. The textures, colours, and creative details quietly invite customers to notice, reflect, and engage. It gives the space character and makes it feel less like just another café and more like a creative environment.

The location of the café also matters. For Tanseem, it is convenient because it is close to where she and her friends live. This closeness allows the café to become part of her routine rather than a place she has to plan a visit to. Being nearby makes it easier to drop in for work, conversations, or even just a break from the day. A few tables away sits Shivani, another student who knows the café well. Unlike a first-time visitor, she moves through the space with familiarity. She comes here often “minimum of like three times in a month,” she said. For her, Dyu Art Café is more than just a café; it is a comfort place. She remembered the first time she came here, during a moment when she was feeling low. Since then, the café has remained a space she returns to whenever she needs comfort, calm, or familiarity. Her relationship with the café feels emotional rather than practical. On some days, she orders her favourite white sauce pasta. On other days, when she isn’t hungry, she sticks to a mocha. The choice of food seems secondary to the act of being there. The sound of cups being placed on tables, the background music, and the steady presence of people around her seem to offer reassurance without demanding attention. When talking about what makes Dyu Art Café unique, Shivani focused on how the space “occupies people in

different ways.” She pointed out that the café attracts different types of crowds: students, working professionals, groups of friends, and individuals spending time alone. Everyone seems to fit in without standing out. The café allows people to exist in their own ways, whether they are socialising, working, or simply sitting quietly. For her, the location of the café is one of its best features. “When something is your comfort place then it has to be close to you,” she said. Being just five minutes away from where she lives makes it easier for the café to become a part of her everyday life. It does not feel like a special destination but rather a familiar space she can return to whenever she needs. Both Tanseem and Shivani agree that Dyu Art Café offers more than just food. The experience comes from a mix of elements: the ambience, the art, the natural features built into the infrastructure, and the sense of comfort it provides. Many people come here not only for the food but also for how the space makes them feel. There is something about the open structure, the artistic details, and the relaxed atmosphere that encourages people to stay longer than they planned. Located in Koramangala, Dyu Art Café has become popular among students and working professionals alike. It offers affordable food and a welcoming environment, which helps build a loyal group of customers. However, what truly keeps people coming back is not just the price or the menu. It is the way the café blends creativity, comfort, and community into one space. Sitting inside Dyu Art Café, watching people come and go, it becomes clear that the café means different things to different people. For some, it is a workspace. For others, it is an escape from college schedules, a meeting point with friends, or a place to sit with their thoughts. The café does not force any particular experience onto its customers. Instead, it quietly adapts to their needs. As the light outside slowly changes and the café fills with evening conversations, Dyu Art Café continues to exist as a pause within the city—a place where art, food, and people come together naturally. It is not loud or dramatic in what it offers, but subtle and steady. And perhaps that is why, for many students like Tanseem and Shivani, it becomes less of a café and more of a feeling they keep returning to.